Closeout Report: Tablet Rollout`

Project Summary

Sauce & Spoon Tabletop Menu Tablet Pilot Project tested a digital tabletop ordering system at two pilot locations to improve customer experience, operational efficiency, and order accuracy. The pilot successfully collected customer feedback, identified strengths and improvement areas, and provided recommendations to support a successful full-scale rollout.

Methodology

The project employed a hybrid project management methodology that combined traditional and agile methodology. The initial planning and scheduling phase followed a traditional approach, focusing on hardware setup, staff training, resource allocation, and system integration planning to establish a clear project foundation. During the test launch, agile principles were applied by collecting real-time stakeholder and customer feedback, enabling iterative improvements to the tablet interface, workflow processes, and staff training based on issues identified during pilot implementation. This hybrid methodology provided both the structured planning and governance of traditional project management and the flexibility of agile practices, ensuring effective project evaluation, continuous improvement, and organizational learning.

Results

Performance Baseline:

	Planned	Actual	Notes
Actual Project Schedule vs Planned	Launch on Apr. 23	Launched on Apr. 23	We were able to launch on the day we wanted, but had to accelerate our

			tasks due to delays
Actual Project Cost vs Planned	Training materials and fees: $10,000 Hardware and software implementation across locations: $3,500 Maintenance (IT fees): $5,000 Updated website and menu design fee: $5,000 Other customization fees: $550	Training materials and fees: $7,486 Hardware and software implementation across locations: $3,600 annually Maintenance (IT fees): $0 (included with hardware order subscription) Updated website and menu design fee: $4,250 Other customization fees: $578	Overall, we nearly matched our budget
Planned Scope vs Delivered Scope	Install tablets at two restaurant locations Launch at the beginning of Q2 (April 1) Create a plan for how to train staff on the new system	Physically installed tablets at two restaurant locations via electrician Added menus, coupons, branding, and additional content to tablets Integrated tablets with POS system Negotiated with tablet vendor over timing Created a plan for training Managed waitstaff expectations and concerns Trained BOH and FOH Created system for maintenance/locking Implemented system of surveying and measuring customer satisfaction	We didn't realize how many moving pieces we were going to encounter

Key Accomplishments:

- **Successful Launch** - Successfully implemented the tablet-based ordering system at the North and Downtown pilot bar locations, completing hardware installation, system configuration, POS integration, and comprehensive staff training according to the project plan, ensuring both sites were fully operational.
- **Achieved Key Goals** –
    - Reduced average table turn time by **30** minutes and checkout time stayed at one

minute or less.
    - Increased average daily guest count by **20%**, surpassing the original target of **10%** at the Downtown location.
    - Achieved a **25%** reduction in food waste through improved order accuracy and collaboration with kitchen staff.
- **Improved Customer Experience** – Based on pilot feedback, the tablet navigation was simplified, resulting in **72%** of customers rating their experience as Good or Great, **82%** finding the checkout process quick, easy, and secure, and **88%** reporting no technical issues during their dining experience.
- **Reduced Technical Issues** - Introduced a pre-service tablet testing checklist to identify faulty devices before customer use, reducing weekly customer-reported technical issues to **below 5%** and successfully achieving the project objective.

Lessons Learned

- **Unforeseen Challenges** - The pilot revealed issues with tablet navigation, payment communication, order accuracy, and occasional tablet freezes. These were addressed by simplifying the user interface, clarifying payment options, introducing pre-service tablet testing, and improving operational processes.
- **Effective Communication** - Regular communication and collaboration among the project manager, general managers, waitstaff, kitchen staff, and technical teams helped resolve issues quickly.
- **Additional Training of Staffs** - Additional training enabled waitstaff to better guide customers, manage guest pacing, and reduce table turn time. Reinforcing operational procedures also contributed to smoother adoption of the new system.
- **Continuous Improvement** - Additional training enabled waitstaff to better guide customers, manage guest pacing, and reduce table turn time. Reinforcing operational procedures also contributed to smoother adoption of the new system.

Next Steps

- **Ongoing Maintenance -** The tablet ordering system will continue to be maintained by the IT vendor under the existing hardware subscription agreement, ensuring regular software updates, preventive maintenance, security patches, and technical support. Restaurant staff will also continue performing pre-service tablet checks to minimize technical issues and maintain a reliable, high-quality customer experience.
- **Future Rollouts -** Sauce & Spoon will roll out the tablet ordering system across all restaurant locations, using lessons learned to ensure standardized training, staff readiness, effective customer communication, and continuous performance monitoring.
- **Post-Project Evaluation -** Following project closure, a post-implementation evaluation will be conducted to assess the long-term effectiveness of the tablet ordering system and verify that expected business benefits are being sustained.

- **Improvement in Order Accuracy -** Order accuracy improved through a combination of guest self-ordering, enhanced communication between the waitstaff and kitchen staff, and strengthened kitchen order verification processes.
- **Ownership Moving Forward -** Project ownership for future tablet rollouts will be formally transferred to Molly Edwards, who will lead the planning, coordination, and execution of upcoming implementations. All project documentation, lessons learned, operational procedures, and maintenance guidelines will be handed over to ensure continuity, support informed decision-making, and promote consistent application of best practices across future deployments.

Project Documentation Archive

- Project Charter_4.pdf
- Project Task.mpp
- Stackholder Analysis.pptx
- Sauce-Spoon-Test-Launch-Findings.pptx